Freedom of speech and the other freedoms encompassed by the First Amendment always have been viewed as fundamental components of the liberty safeguarded by the Due Process Clause, see *Gitlow* v. *New York,* 268 U. S. 652, 666 (1925) (opinion of the Court); *id.,* at 672 (Holmes, J., dissenting); *NAACP* v. *Alabama ex rel. Patterson,* 357 U. S. 449, 460 (1958); *Stromberg* v. *California,* 283 U. S. 359, 368 (1931); *De Jonge* v. *Oregon,* 299 U. S. 353, 364 (1937); Warren, The New "Liberty" Under the Fourteenth Amendment, 39 Harv. L. Rev. 431 (1926), and the Court has not identified a separate source for the right when it has been asserted by corporations.[15] See, *e. g., Times Film Corp.* v. *Chicago,* 365 U. S. 43, 47 (1961); *Kingsley Int'l Pictures Corp.* v. *Regents,* 360 U. S. 684, 688 (1959); *Joseph Burstyn, supra.* In *Grosjean* v. *American Press Co.,* 297 U. S. 233, 244 (1936), the Court rejected the very reasoning adopted by the Supreme Judicial Court and did not rely on the corporation's property rights under the Fourteenth Amendment in sustaining its freedom of speech.[16]

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[15] It has been settled for almost a century that corporations are persons within the meaning of the Fourteenth Amendment. *Santa Clara County* v. *Southern Pacific R. Co.,* 118 U. S. 394 (1886); see *Covington & Lexington Turnpike R. Co.* v. *Sandford,* 164 U. S. 578 (1896).

[16] The appellant in *Grosjean* argued that "[t]he liberty guaranteed by the fourteenth amendment against deprivation without due process of law is the liberty of NATURAL not of artificial persons." Brief for Appellant in *Grosjean* v. *American Press Co.,* O. T. 1935, No. 303, p. 42; see 297 U. S., at 235. See also *Hague* v. *CIO,* 307 U. S. 496, 518 (1939) (opinion of Stone, J.). But see *NAACP* v. *Alabama ex rel. Patterson,* 357 U. S. 449 (1958); *NAACP* v. *Button,* 371 U. S. 415 (1963).

The semantic reasoning of the court below would lead logically to the conclusion that the protection afforded speech by corporations, or, for that matter, other artificial entities and associations, would differ depending on whether the source of the alleged abridgment was a State or the Federal Government. But the States do not have greater latitude than Congress to abridge freedom of speech. The dissenting opinion of Mr. Justice Rehnquist, *post,* at 823, is predicated on the view that the First Amend-